How We Work — Operations Playbook

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1. Purpose

This playbook establishes a standardized approach for managing IT delivery and Business-As-Usual (BAU) operations in a simulated enterprise technology environment.

It provides guidance on work item tracking, Jira ticket hygiene, blocker management, operational reporting, stakeholder communication, and continuous improvement.

Key Objectives:

- Improve visibility into operational activities and delivery progress.
- Ensure clear ownership and accountability for work items.
- Maintain accurate and up-to-date Jira information.
- Identify overdue tasks, blockers, and potential delivery risks.
- Establish consistent documentation and reporting practices.
- Support timely communication and appropriate escalation.

2. Scope

This playbook covers the following simulated operational activities:

- IT incident tracking and follow-up
- Vulnerability remediation coordination
- Change management and release tracking
- Application and infrastructure support activities
- Operational documentation and knowledge management
- Weekly reporting and stakeholder updates

This document is intended for educational and portfolio demonstration purposes.

3. Tools and Responsibilities

Tool	Purpose

Jira	Manage tickets, workflows, priorities, deadlines, and operational dashboards
Confluence	Maintain playbooks, runbooks, checklists, and process documentation
Microsoft Excel	Maintain operational trackers and prepare status reports

Jira serves as the primary source of truth for ticket status and ownership. Excel reports represent snapshots of Jira data at a defined reporting time.

4. Jira Work Item Lifecycle

The project follows a Kanban-based workflow consisting of four statuses.

Status	Description	Expected Action
To Do	The work item has been recorded but work has not started	Review priority and assign an owner
In Progress	The responsible team is actively working on the item	Maintain progress updates
Blocked	Work cannot proceed due to an unresolved dependency	Record the blocker, owner, impact, and next action
Done	Work has been completed and the outcome documented	Verify completion evidence

Workflow Guidelines

1. Every new ticket should have a clear summary and description.
2. Each ticket must have an assigned owner and an appropriate priority.
3. Ticket status must reflect the actual progress of the work.
4. Blocked tickets require documented dependencies and follow-up actions.
5. Tickets should move to Done only after the acceptance criteria are satisfied.
6. Completed work should include a summary of the resolution or supporting documentation.

5. Ticket Quality Standards

To maintain consistent Jira data quality, every ticket should include the following information.

Field	Requirement
Summary	Clear and actionable task description
Description	Background, expected outcome, action items, and acceptance criteria
Assignee	Responsible individual
Priority	Highest, High, Medium, or Low
Due Date	Expected completion deadline
Labels	Relevant operational category
Status	Accurate workflow status
Comments	Meaningful updates, blockers, and follow-up actions

Recommended Description Structure

Background: Explain the business or technical context.

Expected Outcome: Describe the expected result.

Action Items: List the actions required to complete the work.

Acceptance Criteria: Define the conditions required for completion.

6. Priority Management

The following priority definitions are used in this training simulation.

Priority	Definition
Highest	Critical operational issue requiring urgent attention
High	Significant operational or delivery risk
Medium	Standard operational task with moderate impact

Low	Routine documentation or administrative activity

Priority should reflect operational impact and urgency rather than personal preference.

7. Blocker Management and Escalation

A ticket is considered Blocked when its progress depends on an unresolved issue, external approval, missing information, or another team.

Blocker Handling Procedure

1. Change the Jira ticket status to Blocked.
2. Document the blocker and its operational impact.
3. Identify the responsible team or blocker owner.
4. Define the next action and follow-up date.
5. Communicate the dependency to the appropriate stakeholders.
6. Escalate if the blocker threatens the delivery deadline or creates significant operational risk.
7. Update the ticket when new information becomes available.

Required Blocker Information

- Blocker description
- Impact on delivery or operations
- Responsible team
- Next action
- Follow-up deadline
- Escalation requirement

Example — IDBO-12

Ticket: Coordinate UAT sign-off for mobile release

Status: Blocked

Blocker: Pending UAT approval from the Business UAT Lead.

Impact: The planned mobile application release may be delayed.

Next Action: Follow up with the Business UAT Lead to confirm outstanding UAT issues and obtain documented approval.

Escalation: Inform the Release Manager if the missing approval puts the delivery deadline at risk.

Type	Key	Summary	Assignee	Priority	Status	Updated
☑	IDBO-12	Coordinate UAT sign-off for mobile release	Peter Phan	High	Blocked	Oct 30, 2026, 11:33

Synced just now • 1 item

Current Blocked Work Items

Key	Summary	Assignee	Priority	Status	Updated
IDBO-25	Archive completed release evidence	Peter Phan	Low	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-24	Reconcile duplicate monitoring notifications	Peter Phan	Medium	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-23	Update new joiner IT onboarding checklist	Peter Phan	Low	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-22	Close resolved authentication incident records	Peter Phan	Medium	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-21	Publish weekly change calendar	Peter Phan	Low	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-20	Validate database patch in test environment	Peter Phan	Highest	Done	Oct 30, 2026, 13:38
IDBO-19	Await vendor update on API gateway error	Peter Phan	High	Done	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-18	Resolve firewall approval dependency	Peter Phan	High	Done	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-17	Confirm security log retention controls	Peter Phan	High	Done	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-16	Prepare access recertification summary	Peter Phan	Medium	Done	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-15	Validate production release checklist	Peter Phan	High	Done	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-14	Review monitoring alert noise	Peter Phan	Medium	Blocked	Oct 30, 2026, 11:33
IDBO-13	Update change management tracker	Peter Phan	Medium	Blocked	Oct 30, 2026, 11:33
IDBO-12	Coordinate UAT sign-off for mobile release	Peter Phan	High	Blocked	Oct 30, 2026, 11:33
IDBO-11	Investigate batch payment processing delay	Peter Phan	Highest	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-10	Assess stale service account inventory	Peter Phan	High	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-9	Refresh disaster recovery contact list	Peter Phan	Low	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-8	Confirm patch rollout schedule	Peter Phan	Medium	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-7	Validate access review evidence	Peter Phan	Medium	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-6	Review failed overnight backup jobs	Peter Phan	High	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:28
IDBO-5	Document incident escalation procedure	Peter Phan	Low	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 10:04
IDBO-4	Investigate API response time degradation	Peter Phan	High	Blocked	Oct 30, 2026, 11:23
IDBO-3	Update weekly IT operations report	Peter Phan	Medium	In Progress	Oct 30, 2026, 11:25
IDBO-2	Review pending security patches	Peter Phan	Highest	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 09:52
IDBO-1	Investigate intermittent login failures	Peter Phan	High	To Do	Oct 30, 2026, 13:38

Synced just now • 25 items

8. Jira Hygiene Management

Jira hygiene refers to maintaining accurate, complete, and actionable work item information.

The following categories should be monitored regularly.

8.1. Overdue Tickets

An overdue ticket is an incomplete work item with a due date before the current reporting date.

JQL Query:

```
project = IDBO AND statusCategory != Done AND due < startOfDay() ORDER BY due ASC
```

Required Actions:

- Review the overdue ticket.
- Confirm the current status with the assigned owner.
- Identify the reason for the delay.
- Document the next action and follow-up deadline.
- Escalate significant delivery risks when necessary.

8.2. Blocked Tickets

JQL Query:

```
project = IDBO AND status = Blocked ORDER BY priority DESC
```

Required Actions:

- Review the blocker description.
- Confirm responsible owners and dependencies.
- Track pending follow-up actions.
- Escalate unresolved blockers when appropriate.

8.3. Stale Tickets

For this project, a stale ticket is defined as an incomplete work item that has not been updated for at least seven days.

JQL Query:

```
project = IDBO AND statusCategory != Done AND updated <= "-7d" ORDER BY updated ASC
```

Required Actions:

- Contact the ticket owner.
- Confirm whether the task is still relevant.
- Request an accurate status update.
- Review the next action and deadline.
- Consider closure only after confirming the work is no longer required or has been completed.

The project also uses the label `stale-simulated` to demonstrate stale-ticket reporting without modifying actual Jira timestamps.

8.4. Unassigned Tickets

JQL Query:

```
project = IDBO AND assignee IS EMPTY ORDER BY priority DESC
```

All active work items should have a clearly identified accountable owner.

8.5. Duplicate Tickets

Potential duplicate tickets should be compared using their summaries, descriptions, affected systems, and expected outcomes.

Duplicates must not be closed automatically based only on similar titles. The relationship between the records should be confirmed first.

9. Daily BAU Operations Routine

The IT Operations Coordinator should perform the following activities during the daily review:

1. Review newly created Jira tickets.
2. Check High and Highest priority items.
3. Identify overdue and blocked work items.
4. Review tickets without assigned owners.
5. Follow up on outstanding dependencies.
6. Verify ticket status and documentation quality.
7. Update operational tracking records.
8. Escalate urgent issues to the appropriate lead.

10. Weekly Operations Reporting

A weekly IT Operations Status Report should provide stakeholders with a clear view of delivery progress and operational risks.

Required Metrics

- Total tickets
- Open tickets
- Completed tickets
- Tickets by status
- Tickets by priority
- Overdue tickets
- Blocked tickets
- Stale tickets

- Unassigned tickets

Reporting Procedure

1. Review Jira dashboard data.
2. Check the accuracy of ticket status and ownership.
3. Export or update the Excel tracker if required.
4. Summarize key achievements and outstanding issues.
5. Highlight important blockers, overdue items, and risks.
6. Identify upcoming deadlines and actions.
7. Prepare the report for stakeholder review.

Reports must specify their reporting date and distinguish actual Jira results from simulated training scenarios.

11. Stakeholder Communication

All operational communications should be:

- Clear and concise
- Professional and respectful
- Based on confirmed information
- Action-oriented
- Timely and appropriately prioritized

A useful status update should answer:

1. What is the current status?
2. What has been completed?
3. What is blocking progress?
4. Who owns the next action?
5. When is the next update expected?

Unverified assumptions should not be presented as confirmed findings.

12. Risk and Control Awareness

The IT Operations Coordinator may support tracking and reporting for vulnerability remediation, control-related activities, and operational risks.

Responsibilities include:

- Tracking remediation status and ageing.
- Monitoring agreed deadlines.
- Recording unresolved dependencies.
- Following up with responsible technical teams.

- Preparing status information for review.

Technical remediation decisions, risk acceptance, and formal control approvals remain the responsibility of authorized personnel.

13. Continuous Improvement

The team should periodically review opportunities to:

- Reduce outdated and duplicate Jira items.
- Improve ticket descriptions and acceptance criteria.
- Standardize reporting templates.
- Improve documentation consistency.
- Reduce repetitive manual reporting.
- Improve visibility into blockers and delivery risks.

14. Related Project Resources

- Jira Project: IDBO — IT Delivery & BAU Operations
- Dashboard: IDBO - IT Operations Health Dashboard
- Saved Filter: IDBO - Blocked Tickets
- Saved Filter: IDBO - Overdue Open Tickets
- Saved Filter: IDBO - Simulated Stale Tickets
- Saved Filter: IDBO - Unassigned Tickets

15. Document Maintenance

Review Frequency: When operational procedures change or improvements are identified.

Document Owner: IT Operations Coordinator (Simulated)

Version: 1.0

Disclaimer: This playbook is part of a personal IT Operations portfolio simulation. All tickets, processes, responsibilities, and scenarios are illustrative and do not represent HSBC's internal operational policies or real banking incidents.